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CORPORATE TREASURY RESEARCH

The Next Generation of Cross-Border Payments

How Corporate Treasurers Are Evaluating and Implementing Stablecoins

The infrastructure that moves money across borders has not changed in decades. This report outlines the friction, operational inefficiencies and compounding costs of today's cross-border payment system, what leading organizations are already doing, and the key considerations for corporate treasury teams weighing a stablecoin pilot.

Robert Valdes-Rodriguez
Founder & CEO, Digital Asset Global Advisors

daga.io
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Executive Summary

Cross-border payment infrastructure was designed in the 1970s. SWIFT, correspondent banking, and the prefunding requirements that underpin international wire transfers were practical, innovative solutions when they were built. They remain reliable, but they carry costs that most corporate treasuries may not fully quantify. They operate under constraints that a new generation of payment solutions has largely eliminated.

Stablecoins are digital currencies pegged to an underlying asset or currency, most commonly the US dollar. Settlement is in minutes, around the clock, at a fraction of the cost of a wire transfer. Only a handful of companies have disclosed their use publicly, among them SpaceX, Scale AI and Hyundai. Actual usage runs well ahead of that. An EY-Parthenon survey of 350 corporate and financial institution executives found 13% already using stablecoins, with a further 54% of non-users expecting to adopt within a year. And the data shows that B2B adoption is growing at 733% year over year.

Drawing on decades of experience at global banks, advising institutions on currency exposures and cross-border payments, we published this report to look at where the current system creates the most friction and cost. We explore how stablecoins offer an alternative and what leading organizations are already doing. From there, we look at what a first pilot can look like, including a snapshot of the industry's leading infrastructure providers.

Key findings

$31.7T

addressable B2B market

Global B2B cross-border payments in 2024, growing to $47.8 trillion by 2032. Supplier payments, vendor settlements and treasury flows account for the majority of that volume.

$390B

in stablecoin payment volume

Approximately $390 billion a year, annualized from December 2025 activity and more than double 2024 levels. B2B is about $226 billion of that.

733%

annual B2B growth

The rate at which B2B stablecoin payment volume is compounding, measured on payment activity, not headline transaction volume.

13%

already use stablecoins

Of 350 executives surveyed, 13% already use stablecoins and 54% of non-users expect to adopt within a year. Among users, 41% report cost savings of at least 10%.

ALSO IN THIS REPORT

Legacy cost

A standard SWIFT wire costs $25 to $50 and takes one to five business days. Delay interest is rarely itemized.

Regulatory certainty

The GENIUS Act is law and MiCA is in force. Frameworks across Asia, the UAE and Mexico are advancing.

Where investment capital is going

Mastercard acquired BVNK for $1.8 billion and Stripe acquired Bridge for $1.1 billion.

01

The State of Cross-Border Payments

Where things stand and why the status quo is changing

The global cross-border payments market processed approximately $200 trillion in 2025, according to McKinsey. That number includes most treasury activities, such as trade payments, remittances, and corporate payments. When you layer the larger wholesale interbank FX market and securities settlement on top of it, the IMF estimates total cross-border payment activity closer to an eye-popping $1 quadrillion. Of the $200 trillion, B2B transactions, covering supplier payments, vendor settlements, intercompany transfers, and treasury flows, account for approximately $31.7 trillion in volume, growing at roughly 8% per year according to FXC Intelligence.

That is an enormous market. It is also a market that still largely relies on SWIFT and global correspondent banking infrastructure built in the 1970s.

The scale of cross-border payments (annual)

$1 quadrillion Total cross-border payment activity

OF WHICH

$200 trillion Real-economy flows

OF WHICH

$31.7 trillion B2B cross-border, fee-bearing

The correspondent banking model

When a multinational corporation sends a cross-border wire transfer, it travels through a chain of correspondent banks that maintain accounts with one another. Each bank processes the payment within its own batch windows and takes its own fee. A payment from a US parent company to a subsidiary in Mexico may pass through two to four intermediary banks before arriving.

This model was a practical solution to moving money reliably between institutions in different countries with different currencies and regulatory frameworks. It works and has always worked. Over time, though, the inefficiencies at each step of the payment chain create structural costs that compound across large payment programs.

It is also worth acknowledging that SWIFT and its member banks have invested heavily in modernization. SWIFT gpi has brought real-time tracking and materially faster settlement to a large share of transactions, particularly in developed market corridors. The industry migration from the legacy MT messaging standard to ISO 20022 is improving data quality and straight-through processing. The clearest evidence yet came in July 2026, when SWIFT moved its own blockchain

ledger into a live pilot with 17 major banks, including HSBC, UBS, Citi, BNY, and BNP Paribas, aimed at enabling 24/7 payment movement using tokenized bank deposits. These are real improvements, but they don't resolve the structural issue. Final settlement in SWIFT's pilot still routes through existing correspondent rails, and the reliance on multiple correspondent relationships. The biggest problems are still in emerging markets and smaller cross-border payments, exactly where many corporate treasury payments occur.

The cross-border payment market | key data

- Total global cross-border payments: approximately $200 trillion per year | McKinsey Global Payments Report, 2025
- B2B cross-border payments: $31.7 trillion in 2024, growing to $47.8 trillion by 2032 | FXC Intelligence, 2025
- Bank wire transfers: 73.4% of B2B cross-border payment value | Grand View Research, 2025
- Average SWIFT wire fee: $25 to $50 per transfer, plus correspondent deductions and FX spread

Source: McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025; FXC Intelligence 2025; Grand View Research 2025

The four friction points that hurt the most

1. Settlement time and working capital

When a payment is in transit, the cash is unavailable at the destination. This is the difference between a payment that settles in days and one that settles in minutes. For a multinational with $100 million in cross-border payments in transit at any given time, even a two-day average settlement time means that capital sits idle, earning nothing and unavailable for operations. At a 5% short-term cost of capital (using the Act/360 convention standard), that represents approximately $13,900 per day in implicit financing cost, or roughly $5 million per year at that level of cash in transit. Reducing settlement time by even a single day is a meaningful unlock of working capital for a payment program running into the hundreds of millions.

2. Cut-off times and availability

SWIFT operates on banking hours. A payment initiated after a bank's cut-off time, typically early to mid-afternoon, begins processing the next business day. On a Friday afternoon, that means Monday. Public holidays in either the sending or receiving country add more. Beyond the operational burden of tracking cut-off windows across time zones, this is a direct cause of the settlement delays and late payments described elsewhere in this section. Buffer balances kept at subsidiaries to cover for uncertain timing represent capital tied up unnecessarily. Visa has cited this exact problem as the reason behind its own Visa Direct stablecoin prefunding pilot, announced in September 2025, for cross-border payouts. A business paying overseas workers over a weekend previously had to hold days of collateral in advance, with no way to top up the account if it ran low on a Saturday, because the bank was closed until Monday. SWIFT's own July 2026 pilot with 17 banks attempts to fix this specific problem by enabling 24/7 payment movement, but it remains a pilot today, and final settlement still depends on the same correspondent rails described throughout this section.

3. Intermediary fees and late payment interest

Each correspondent bank in the payment chain can apply its own fee, and a single cross-border wire may pass through two to four intermediary banks before reaching its destination. These deductions are often invisible to the sender. The amount that arrives at the destination is not always the amount that was sent. Reconciling the difference falls to treasury teams. For an organization running thousands of cross-border payments a month, these intermediary fees compound into a cost that rarely appears as its own line item, embedded instead across dozens of individual wire confirmations.

Late payment interest compounds this. When a payment arrives late, the receiving entity may need to borrow locally to cover the gap. The impact is largest where short-term rates are highest, and in many emerging market corridors even a two or three-day delay on a significant transfer generates meaningful interest cost. It is one of the most consistently underestimated costs in corporate treasury, absorbed into financing costs rather than appearing as a distinct line item.

Illustrative example | USD/MXN supplier payment corridor

Cost by delay length, on a $10M transfer at Mexico's 6.50% overnight rate:

1-day delay: approximately $1,806

2-day delay: approximately $3,611

3-day delay (weekend plus a public holiday): approximately $5,417

Most late payments run 1 to 2 days rather than the full holiday scenario. Appendix A calculates this for your own volume and delay frequency.

Excludes direct wire fees and the operational cost of managing the delay

4. Reconciliation burden and lack of transparency

A SWIFT payment generates a reference number and a paper trail that typically requires reconciliation across multiple systems. Because correspondent deductions are taken from the transfer rather than billed, treasury sees a shortfall without knowing which bank took what. Confirming that a specific payment has settled and producing the documentation to prove it can take hours or days in corridors with less developed banking infrastructure. (Sutton & Otendal, Treasury Management International, 2026; BIS Papers No. 167, 2026. See Appendix C for full source detail.)

A Story From 25 Years in FX

More than two decades ago we sold a large multinational roughly $100 million of Mexican pesos for T+2 settlement. Our back office sent incorrect payment instructions, and the error surfaced only when the client flagged the missing funds on settlement day, a Thursday. With a Mexican holiday on the Monday, the funds arrived Tuesday, five calendar days late.

At an annualized funding rate of approximately 14%, the delay generated roughly $194,000 in late payment interest charges. The error was ours, so the bank absorbed that cost, which nearly wiped out the revenue earned on the trade. I remember it 25 years later because of how fast a simple operational error became an expensive one. Technology has advanced and interest rates are lower, but the underlying friction remains. Stablecoin settlement removes delays like this, in minutes, with a verifiable record for both parties.

02

The Market in Numbers

What the data shows about adoption, growth, and opportunity

When looking at stablecoin adoption, it's useful to separate headline transaction volume, which is dominated by trading and wholesale financial activity, and underlying payment volume, which is more relevant for corporate treasurers.

Total stablecoin transaction volume reached $33 trillion in 2025, surpassing the combined transaction volume of Visa and Mastercard for the first time. That number is widely cited. It is also significantly misleading for a treasury audience. The overwhelming majority of that volume represents crypto trading, DeFi activity, arbitrage, and automated smart contract loops, not end-user payments.

Headline volume is not payment volume



McKinsey and Artemis Analytics estimated stablecoin payment activity, covering real supplier invoices, payroll, remittances, and B2B settlements, at approximately $390 billion a year, annualized from December 2025 activity. That is the number that counts for this audience. And B2B, the largest segment, has grown 733% year over year. Stripe reported a comparable figure independently. In its 2025 annual letter it put stablecoin payment volume at roughly $400 billion for the year, with volume through Bridge, its stablecoin infrastructure subsidiary, growing more than fourfold.

733%

annual B2B payment growth

Measured on payment activity, excluding trading and automated volume.

41%

report 10%+ cost savings

Of corporates already using stablecoins for cross-border B2B payments.

McKinsey and Artemis Analytics, February 2026; EY-Parthenon, June 2025.

The full data picture

Metric	Volume	Context	Source
Global FX market daily volume	$9.5 trillion/day	Record high, up 28% from 2022. Largest financial market globally.	BIS Triennial Survey, April 2025
Total global cross-border payments	~$200 trillion/year	All types including B2B, consumer, remittances, and interbank.	McKinsey Global Payments Report, 2025
B2B cross-border payments	$31.7 trillion in 2024	Growing to $47.8 trillion by 2032. The primary corporate treasury opportunity.	FXC Intelligence, 2025
Stablecoin payment volume	~$390 billion annualized	Annualized from December 2025 activity. Excludes trading, DeFi, and automated loops. Real end-user payments only.	McKinsey / Artemis Analytics, Feb 2026
B2B share of actual stablecoin payments	$226 billion (58%)	Supply chain, cross-border settlements, treasury management.	McKinsey / Artemis Analytics, Feb 2026
B2B stablecoin payment growth	733% year-over-year	Among payment companies tracked by Artemis, monthly B2B volume rose from under $100M (early 2023) to over $6B (mid-2025). B2B is roughly 60% of total payment activity.	Artemis Analytics, 2025
Stablecoin penetration of B2B payments	~0.7% of $31.7T	The size of the runway remaining.	DAGA calculation based on above sources
Projected stablecoin share by 2030	5 to 10% of cross-border payments	Representing $2.1 to $4.2 trillion in annual B2B stablecoin payment volume.	EY-Parthenon Survey, June 2025
Corporates reporting 10%+ cost savings	41% of current users	Among corporates already using stablecoins for cross-border B2B payments.	EY-Parthenon Survey, June 2025
Supplier payments as top use case	77% of corporate users	The dominant use case among corporates currently using stablecoins.	EY-Parthenon Survey, June 2025

Source: BIS Triennial Survey 2025; McKinsey / Artemis Analytics February 2026; FXC Intelligence 2025; EY-Parthenon June 2025; Grand View Research 2025; Artemis Analytics 2025

What independent research firms are projecting

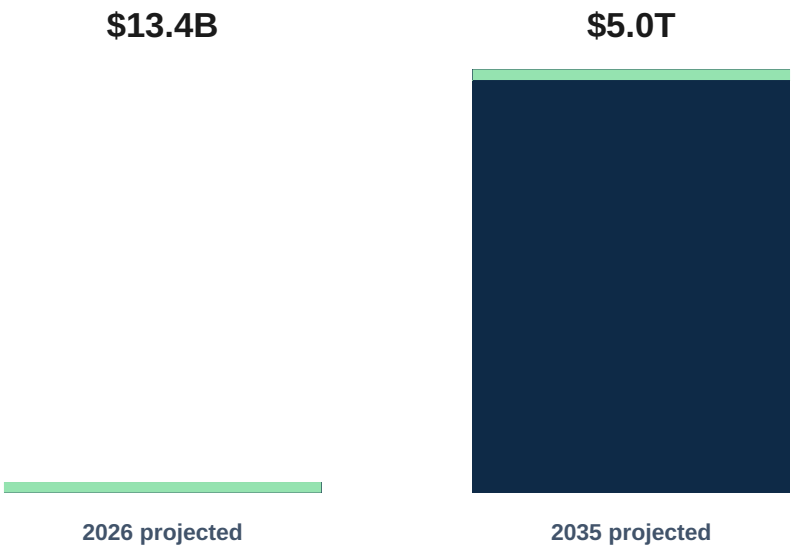
Beyond the transaction data, several independent research firms have published forward projections that provide additional context for corporate treasury planning.

- Juniper Research, April 2026: Cross-border B2B stablecoin payments will reach $5 trillion by 2035, up from $13.4 billion in 2026, a 373-fold increase. The firm projects that 85% of all stablecoin transaction value in 2035 will come from B2B use cases. "Cross-border B2B is where the advantages are greatest, and where we expect the most sustained volume growth over the forecast period," said Juniper Research Analyst Jawad Jahan. Source: Juniper Research press release via GlobeNewswire, April 27, 2026.
- Forrester Research, Predictions 2026: Payments: B2B cross-border transactions are among the highest-priority use cases for stablecoin adoption, with the sector described as ripe for disruption given persistent delays, high fees, currency volatility, and fragmented infrastructure. Source: Forrester Research, Predictions 2026: Payments, published late 2025.

- EY-Parthenon, June 2025: 56% of financial institutions believe 5 to 10% of global cross-border payment value will be settled using stablecoins by 2030, representing $2.1 to $4.2 trillion annually.
- US Treasury projection: Stablecoin supply is projected to reach $3 trillion by 2030. Citi's base case projects $1.9 trillion in stablecoin issuance by 2030, with a bull case of $4 trillion.

While the forecasts vary widely, they all point to the same conclusion. B2B cross-border payments are emerging as the leading institutional use case for stablecoins. Adoption is accelerating, and the infrastructure is ready for corporate use today.

B2B cross-border stablecoin payments, projected



Juniper projects a 373-fold increase between 2026 and 2035, with 85% of all stablecoin transaction value coming from B2B use cases by 2035. Citi separately projects $1.9 trillion in total stablecoin issuance by 2030, a different metric.

Juniper Research, April 2026. Single-source series: B2B cross-border stablecoin payment value.

What the infrastructure bets signal

The most reliable indicator of where a market is heading is where the largest incumbents are placing capital. The stablecoin payment infrastructure market has been busy over the past 18 months. We've seen a wave of acquisitions, new partnerships, and shared infrastructure launches. Institutional conviction is gaining momentum at the highest levels.

- Stripe acquired Bridge for $1.1 billion in late 2024 and launched stablecoin payment acceptance across 100+ countries in 2025. Bridge now powers stablecoin payment infrastructure for companies ranging from startups to SpaceX.
- Mastercard acquired BVNK for $1.8 billion, acquiring a leading stablecoin payment infrastructure provider and integrating its capabilities into Mastercard's global network.
- Visa reached $7 billion in annualized stablecoin settlement as of April 2026, up 50% quarter over quarter, spanning nine blockchains, including Circle's Arc, Coinbase's Base, and Canton, and continues to integrate USDC into its core settlement operations. In March 2026 Visa expanded its stablecoin-backed card partnership with Bridge to more than 100 countries, and Bridge joined Visa's pilot settling card transactions in stablecoins rather than through traditional bank transfers.

We are seeing infrastructure bets from the world's largest payment networks and custodian banks. Billions of dollars in capital have already been deployed. The market direction is clear. One of the strongest recent signals came on June 30, 2026, when Open Standard launched Open USD, an issuer-neutral stablecoin backed by more than 140 companies, including BlackRock, Visa, Stripe, Mastercard, Google, and Coinbase. Infrastructure players are hedging across every major stablecoin issuer instead of betting on a single winner. For corporate treasuries, the priority at this stage is understanding the direction of the payment flow, rather than determining which specific stablecoin to evaluate first.

Acquisition spending on stablecoin payment infrastructure



A day earlier, BNY, the world's largest custodian bank, made the same point from a different angle. The bank expanded its partnership with Circle, making USDC the first stablecoin available on BNY's institutional Digital Asset Custody platform. This integration brings custody, minting, and burning into a single workflow. Both developments are still unfolding as this report goes to print and will be important to watch as the market develops. Both examples demonstrate the growing momentum behind stablecoin payment infrastructure.

03

How Stablecoins Work

A practical primer for treasury professionals

A stablecoin is a digital currency pegged to an underlying asset, usually the US dollar. One USD-backed stablecoin is worth one US dollar. It does not fluctuate in value. It is a digital representation of a dollar that moves across the internet in seconds, available around the clock, at a fraction of the cost of a wire transfer.

We believe the most relevant stablecoin for US corporate treasury purposes today is USDC, issued by Circle. As of Q2 2026, USDC has $73.3 billion in circulation, up 19% year over year, backed dollar-for-dollar by cash and short-term US Treasury securities and audited monthly by a major accounting firm. Onchain transaction volume reached $14.8 trillion in the quarter, up 151% year over year. Circle also offers EURC, a MiCA-compliant euro stablecoin. In 2025, they launched the Circle Payments Network (CPN), connecting banks, payment providers, and institutions to enable B2B payments via stablecoins. Reporting Q2 results in August 2026, Circle confirmed it had received its federal trust bank charter and named BlackRock, BNY and Standard Chartered among institutions expanding rather than piloting their USDC support. Its Arc settlement network is scheduled for public mainnet launch on 16 September 2026.

Circle uses USDC for intercompany transfers within its existing treasury and accounting processes. The approach reduces cash in transit and supports a more efficient month-end close without requiring a redesign of its treasury stack.

> "The win isn't just faster settlement. It's faster settlement without weakening controls. With USDC, we keep segregation of duties, approvals, and auditability intact, while getting confirmation on a timeline that matches the business," says Dan Fishman, Circle's Treasurer.
>
> *Circle, 'Treasury Management' case study, circle.com/case-studies/circle-treasury-management*

Tether's USDT remains the largest stablecoin by market capitalisation and holds a commanding share in emerging market corridors, though it is not MiCA authorised. The landscape is moving quickly, so this section should be revisited before your pilot design is finalized.

How settlement works

When a USDC transfer is initiated, the transaction is broadcast to a blockchain network. It is verified across thousands of computers simultaneously and recorded permanently within seconds to minutes. There is no correspondent chain to route through, and no institution in the middle whose cut-off times determine when the payment moves.

For a treasury team, the message is simple. Many of the delays, costs, and constraints are a result of the correspondent banking system itself. A different payment infrastructure changes that.

Money Movement, Traditional Bank Rails vs Stablecoins

	Traditional: SWIFT + Correspondent Banking	Stablecoin (USDC)
Settlement time	1 to 5 business days. SWIFT gpi can settle within 24 hours, but not in all corridors.	Seconds to minutes. Final and irrevocable onchain.
Working Capital	Cash in transit 1 to 5 days. Unavailable until settlement.	Available in minutes. No transit float or buffer balances needed.
Availability	Banking hours with strict cut-off times. Weekends and holidays add days.	24/7/365. No cut-off times.
Payment Finality / Error Correction	Can be amended before settlement, during banking hours.	Irreversible once sent. Requires pre-verification.
Cost Structure	$25-$50 fee plus often invisible correspondent deductions.	$0.10-$1.00 gas fee, plus a separate dealer/platform spread.
FX / Costs and Transparency	Usually embedded in the rate rather than quoted as a separate fee.	Conversion is still required. Pricing depends on your dealer, corridor and market conditions rather than on the settlement rail.
Counterparty Reach	Any SWIFT bank globally. 11,000+ institutions.	Any compatible wallet. No bank account needed.
Credit Risk	Tier 1 & 2 banks (GSIBs), often with implicit government backing.	Issuer risk: reserves, custody, audits. Plus dealer risk when trading.
Transaction Record	Siloed messaging (MT103, UETR). Manual reconciliation, can take days.	Permanent onchain record. Verifiable in seconds.
Regulatory Status	Fully established globally. Decades of precedent.	US, EU, Singapore, Hong Kong, Japan, UAE frameworks in place. Varies by corridor.
Implementation	Already in place. No setup required.	Orchestrator: days to weeks. Independent custody: 3-6 weeks.

Source: DAGA analysis. SWIFT data: SWIFT GPI tracker and correspondent banking cost data. Stablecoin data: Circle Q2 2026 earnings, Ethereum and Solana network data, GENIUS Act text.

Federal Reserve staff analysis

In a March 2026 FEDS Note, Federal Reserve Board staff modelled a cross-border payment between the United States and Mexico and showed how a payment stablecoin could shorten the payment chain, reduce intermediary fees and settlement time, and make payments easier to track. They also note that more than 60% of wholesale payments are currently routed through one or more intermediaries.

The same analysis is explicit that stablecoins do not remove every cost. Fiat conversion and on-ramp and off-ramp charges remain, which is why a corridor should be evaluated on its full economics rather than on onchain transaction fees alone.

Kim, Ruprecht and Styczynski, FEDS Notes, 30 March 2026. FEDS Notes present the authors' own views and are not a policy position of the Federal Reserve Board.

04

Who Is Already Doing This

Corporate and Institutional Adoption

One of the most consistent findings in treasury research is that adoption decisions are driven by peer behavior. Corporate treasurers want evidence that organizations comparable to their own have evaluated, piloted, and implemented a solution before they move.

The following table documents confirmed public examples of corporate and institutional stablecoin adoption for payment and treasury purposes, with sources for each.

Company	Use case	What they are doing	Source
UBS	Cross-border B2B payments	Completed its first real-world stablecoin B2B payments in a proof of concept with selected corporate clients, executed via Merge. Cross-border transfers settled in under two minutes.	UBS Group Executive Board, July 2026
Hyundai	Intercompany cross-border settlement	Completed a stablecoin PoC moving $20,000 USD to USDT to Hyundai Motor Mexico in ~7 minutes, versus 3-4 hours for a traditional transfer. Second phase testing non-USD currencies in Europe with Visa and Circle underway.	The Block, July 2026
SpaceX / Starlink	Cross-border revenue collection	Converts Starlink customer payments from emerging market currencies into stablecoins via Bridge (acquired by Stripe for $1.1B). Eliminates correspondent banking friction and FX risk on EM collections.	TechCrunch, Jan 2025 All-In Podcast, Dec 2024
Scale AI	International contractor payments	Pays overseas contractors in stablecoins, ensuring stable-value, timely payments regardless of local currency conditions. Eliminates banking friction for global gig workforce payments.	Modern Treasury, 2025
Visa	Settlement infrastructure	$7 billion annualized stablecoin settlement as of April 2026, up 50% quarter over quarter, across nine blockchains. USDC integrated into core settlement operations. Card-linked programs enable merchant settlement in stablecoin.	Visa, April 2026
Stripe	Payment infrastructure	Acquired Bridge for $1.1 billion in late 2024. Launched stablecoin payment acceptance across 100+ countries in 2025. Stablecoins available as a settlement option for enterprise clients globally.	Stripe, 2025-2026
Shopify	Merchant settlement	USDC acceptance integrated for merchants. Enables direct settlement to merchant wallets without requiring cryptocurrency expertise or additional infrastructure.	AlphaPoint, 2026
Mastercard	Infrastructure acquisition	Acquired BVNK, a stablecoin payment infrastructure provider, for $1.8 billion. Signals institutional commitment to stablecoin rails at network scale.	Tazapay, 2026
Societe Generale	EUR stablecoin issuance	Issued EURI, the first euro-denominated stablecoin under MiCA, as a licensed European bank. Enables cross-border payments and tokenized transactions within the EU regulatory framework.	AlphaPoint, 2026
PayPal	Consumer stablecoin	Launched PYUSD stablecoin for consumer-to-business and B2B payments. Leveraging 430M+ merchant network for distribution.	Multiple sources, 2025

Source: The Block, July 2026; The Korea Times, July 2026; TechCrunch January 2025; All-In Podcast December 2024; Modern Treasury 2025; AlphaPoint 2026; Visa, April 2026; Tazapay 2026; Stripe 2025-2026; Grayscale Research July 2025

In Practice | Hyundai Motor

Hyundai Motor America converted $20,000 into USDT on Avalanche, sent it to Hyundai Motor Mexico, and converted it back to dollars. The transfer took approximately 7 minutes, versus 3 to 4 hours conventionally. Hyundai Card led the regulatory, tax and internal control review itself. A second phase in Europe uses Circle's USDC, where MiCA authorisation matters, making issuer choice a corridor-level decision.

Source: The Block, July 9, 2026; CoinDesk, July 10, 2026.

In Practice | SpaceX / Starlink

SpaceX partnered with Bridge, a stablecoin payments platform subsequently acquired by Stripe for $1.1 billion, to convert Starlink customer payments from emerging market currencies into stablecoins for its global treasury. The arrangement eliminates correspondent banking friction in markets where traditional financial systems are unreliable or inaccessible, and removes FX exposure on collections from volatile currency markets including Argentina and Nigeria.

Source: TechCrunch, January 2025; Chamath Palihapitiya, All-In Podcast, December 2024

In Practice | Scale AI

Scale AI, a leading AI data company, pays its overseas contractor workforce in stablecoins, ensuring stable-value, timely payments regardless of local currency conditions or banking infrastructure constraints. The arrangement addresses one of the most common pain points in international contractor management, the inability to guarantee prompt, full-value payment in markets with limited banking access.

Source: Modern Treasury, 2025

What the EY-Parthenon survey found

EY-Parthenon surveyed 350 corporate and financial institution executives on stablecoin adoption in June 2025. The findings are worth understanding in detail because they reflect the current state of institutional thinking rather than aspirational projections.

- 77% of corporate users named supplier payments as their primary use case for stablecoins
- 13% are already using stablecoins, and 54% of non-users expect to adopt within six to twelve months
- 52% cited reduced transaction costs as the most important benefit
- 45% cited faster cross-border payments as the primary driver
- 41% of current users report cost savings of at least 10%
- Usage is highest among organizations with $10bn to $50bn in revenue
- 70% would be more willing to adopt if ERP integrations were available

ERP integration has been the main barrier, and it is closing fast. Circle's Kyriba partnership embeds USDC into Kyriba's platform, and SAP's Digital Currency Hub connects to S/4HANA, their ERP suite.

Source: EY-Parthenon, June 2025; Circle / Kyriba, April 2026

05

The Regulatory Picture

Where things stand as of mid-2026

One of the most common reasons treasury teams and General Counsels have paused on stablecoins over the past three years is regulatory uncertainty. That uncertainty has been substantially resolved in many of the relevant jurisdictions for global corporate treasuries.

- United States: The GENIUS Act, signed into law in July 2025, established the first federal licensing framework for stablecoin issuers, requiring 1:1 reserve backing, monthly attestations, and Bank Secrecy Act compliance. Separately, the CLARITY Act, addressing the broader SEC/CFTC jurisdictional split over digital assets, passed the House in July 2025 and advanced through Senate Banking in May 2026, but has not yet passed the full Senate.
- Mexico: No dedicated stablecoin law exists yet. USD-denominated stablecoins fall outside Mexico's virtual asset framework, a gray-area carve-out that has let USD/MXN activity, including Hyundai's, move forward without a clear green light. The Murat Initiative, modeled on the GENIUS Act, would designate Banco de México as regulator; introduced in May 2026, it hasn't passed Congress. Mexican banks can't offer crypto services directly, so pilots run through licensed non-bank providers.
- European Union: MiCA's stablecoin rules have applied since June 2024, with the transitional grandfathering period for crypto-asset service providers expiring July 1, 2026. Every CASP operating in the EU must now hold full MiCA authorization. As of May 2026, roughly 210 providers had secured it, a fraction of the 1,200+ firms previously operating under national regimes, so expect continued consolidation as this deadline takes effect.
- Singapore: MAS finalized its Stablecoin Regulatory Framework requirements in August 2023, covering stablecoins pegged to the Singapore dollar or a G10 currency. Full legal force has taken longer to arrive than in the US or EU, with complete effect expected around mid-2026. Singapore remains a major APAC hub for institutional stablecoin activity, but confirm the framework's exact legal status at pilot time.
- Hong Kong: The Stablecoins Ordinance took effect in August 2025, with the licensing regime now operational. The HKMA granted its first two issuer licenses in April 2026, to HSBC and to Anchorpoint Financial, a joint venture led by Standard Chartered with HKT and Animoca Brands, both for HKD-backed stablecoins.
- UAE: Stablecoins are regulated federally as "payment tokens" by the Central Bank of the UAE, in effect since August 2024. Approved tokens include AE Coin and USDU, the UAE's first USD-backed payment token. Dubai's VARA and Abu Dhabi's ADGM regulate broader virtual asset activity separately, complementing the federal CBUAE framework. It's a key jurisdiction for EM corridor payments to South Asia and Africa.
- Japan: The Payment Services Act has regulated fiat-backed stablecoins since 2023, restricting issuance to licensed banks and trust companies. It opened further on June 1, 2026, when foreign stablecoins like USDC gained access through licensed intermediaries, with full enforcement from June 13, 2026. Momentum across Asia is building quickly; we treat Japan as an emerging corridor worth watching, not yet a primary pilot recommendation.

This regulatory landscape is evolving quickly and unevenly across jurisdictions. Every specific rule, license status, and named licensee in this section should be treated as current only as of mid-2026, and verified directly with your counsel and the relevant regulator before being relied on for a live pilot.

Bring legal and compliance in early

Given how recently these frameworks have taken shape and how unevenly they have matured across jurisdictions, bring your General Counsel or outside counsel into the conversation before your pilot design is finalized. Budget two to four weeks and appropriate legal fees for a jurisdictional analysis covering your specific sending and receiving countries; for the US to Mexico or US to EU corridors, that analysis is generally manageable.

A detailed, corridor-specific compliance checklist for the US, Mexico, Singapore, and EU legs of a pilot is in Appendix D for your legal team to work from directly. DAGA works with treasury teams, walking them through the specifics of each situation.

Key regulatory point

The regulatory picture has changed materially since 2023. If your legal team's view on stablecoin treasury use is more than 12 months old, it reflects a different regulatory environment. Commission a fresh analysis.

The GENIUS Act, MiCA, the Hong Kong stablecoin ordinance, the Singapore MAS framework, and Japan's Payment Services Act all postdate most prior legal opinions on this topic.

06

Designing Your First Pilot

From evaluation to execution

Public disclosure remains limited, but the evidence that does exist points the same direction. SpaceX and Scale AI are already using stablecoins for cross-border payments in production. Hyundai Motor completed a stablecoin cross-border proof of concept on its US-to-Mexico corridor in July 2026 before moving to a second phase in Europe. Federal Reserve Board staff used the same US to Mexico corridor to illustrate the mechanics in a March 2026 FEDS Note. EY-Parthenon's survey of 350 corporate and financial institution executives found 13% already using stablecoins, and 54% of non-users expecting to adopt within six to twelve months. Among current users, 41% report cost savings of at least 10%. Momentum is building. We recommend a low-risk, low-cost pilot on a single corridor, run alongside your existing process, is a sensible way to generate your own data before deciding whether to expand to additional corridors. No need to replace existing infrastructure or banking relationships to get started.

This approach has several advantages. It requires no changes to existing banking relationships. It generates real data from your own payment program rather than relying on external benchmarks. It also gives your legal, compliance, and IT teams a contained scope to work with.

Choosing your first corridor

When choosing your first corridor, consider payment volume, settlement delay frequency, and local borrowing rates. A good starting point is wherever the financial case is most visible. Once that first corridor is validated, the same approach can expand into additional corridors in stages. We have found that the corridors that generate the clearest business case for corporate treasuries are:

- USD to MXN: Mexico is one of the most accessible EM corridors for a stablecoin pilot. Deliverable currency, neighboring time zone, and well-developed banking system. The friction exists nonetheless and with relatively higher short term borrowing rates, the improvement should be measurable.
- USD to EUR: As a dominant G3 corridor, the EU is one of the higher volume payment corridors for U.S. corporate treasurers. While the banking system is highly developed and SWIFT has reduced wire transfer costs, the streamlined, almost instant settlement with stablecoins can have a massive impact on institutional payment programs.
- USD to SGD: A strong APAC starting corridor. Singapore has a developed stablecoin regulatory framework under MAS and significant institutional stablecoin activity.

Non-deliverable currencies with capital controls, including USD/BRL, USD/INR, and USD/KRW, introduce additional settlement complexity. We would recommend these corridors for a later phase, once your team has operational experience on simpler corridors.

Brazil regulatory note | USD/BRL corridor

Brazil's central bank banned fintechs from using stablecoins to settle overseas remittances in April 2026, effective October 2026. It's exactly why we recommend starting with USD to MXN, EUR, or SGD, corridors without capital controls, rather than USD/BRL. Save non-deliverable, capital-controlled corridors like Brazil for a later phase, once your team has direct operational experience.

Source: Brazil Central Bank Resolution 561, April 30, 2026, as reported by CoinDesk, May 2, 2026.

The shape of a pilot

A pilot typically runs 90 to 120 days. If your organization has cross-border intercompany flows, consider testing there first, as Hyundai did, before extending to external supplier payments. We recommend starting with a single corridor; those who move quickly may expand to two or three within that same window. First, quantify the actual cost of friction on your chosen corridor using your own payment data; this becomes your business case. Second, stand up the pilot. Bring in legal and compliance, select a provider (an orchestrator is usually the fastest path for a first pilot), and write a brief treasury policy addendum covering scope and limits. Third, run a portion of your live volume through the new rail alongside your existing process, and compare the two on settlement time, cost, transparency, and operational effort, not cost alone.

DAGA works with clients through each of these phases in detail, from provider selection through policy design to results analysis.

The internal conversations to have early

Loop in your CFO or Treasurer early with the corridor cost calculation; the business case is strongest when it comes from your own data, not external benchmarks. Bring in Legal and Compliance immediately, given how recently these regulatory frameworks have taken shape. Internal audit should be involved from the design phase, so the pilot's audit trail can support future expansion approvals. IT should be involved early enough to provision and review the API connections to your chosen orchestrator. Deep integration work can wait, as manual reconciliation is workable for a test on a single corridor, and full system integration only becomes relevant once you decide to scale.

07

Evaluating Providers

A practical guide to the infrastructure landscape

The digital asset infrastructure market has developed significantly. There are now credible, regulated options across every layer of the stack, from stablecoin issuance and custody through to settlement and compliance. DAGA has no commercial relationship with any provider listed below. All assessments are independent. Most examples in this report reference Circle's USDC stablecoin specifically, as the stablecoin with the clearest regulatory standing for corporate use. It is GENIUS Act compliant, MiCA compliant via EURC, and now operating under a federally chartered national trust bank. Tether's USDT is larger by circulating supply and carries deeper liquidity in many emerging market corridors. It is not MiCA authorised, which is the practical consideration for EU corridors. That underlying framework applies to other regulated stablecoins as well. Provider details below are drawn from company publications, regulatory filings and public announcements, as of mid-2026.

For a first pilot, the practical choice is between two approaches. An orchestrator, such as Bridge, BVNK or Merge, handles KYC/AML, wallet infrastructure, and licensing on your behalf. This is a faster, more affordable path for validating the concept. As a stablecoin program becomes more permanent and large-scale, treasury teams may consider independent infrastructure, such as Coinbase Prime, Fireblocks, or Anchorage Digital. The independent route provides wholesale lower fees, no third-party lock-in, and direct control of custody and tokens. It is a natural next step once a pilot has proven out and volume justifies the investment. Our recommendation is for most treasury teams to start with an orchestrator.

The recipient experience is the part treasury teams most often ask about. An orchestrator settles onchain and pays out in local currency, so the counterparty receives a standard bank payment. Merge, named above, describes the shift this produces.

> "The recipient never sees a stablecoin. They receive a standard local payment. Once treasury teams understand that, the conversation shifts from crypto adoption to payment operations," says Kebbie Sebastian, Chief Executive Officer of Merge.

Whichever model you choose, check with your ERP or treasury management provider first. They may already be integrated with a stablecoin infrastructure partner, as Kyriba now is with both Circle and Merge.

Provider	What it offers	Best suited for	Regulatory status
STABLECOIN ISSUERS			
Circle (USDC)	$73.3B in circulation (Q2 2026). Backed 1:1 by cash and short-term US Treasuries, audited monthly. Also issues EURC.	Broad global reach and the most established compliance record.	GENIUS Act compliant. MiCA compliant via EURC. Federally chartered national trust bank.
Tether (USDT)	Largest stablecoin by circulating supply, roughly 59% of the market, with deep EM corridor liquidity.	Emerging market corridors, where it often carries the deepest liquidity.	Not MiCA authorised, and delisted for EEA customers by the major regulated exchanges. EU exposure requires self-custody or a non-EU provider.
JPM Coin	Tokenized bank deposit on JPMorgan's private network, for vetted institutional clients only.	Existing JPMorgan clients wanting a bank-issued option.	Bank-regulated. Operates within JPMorgan's existing perimeter.
ORCHESTRATORS (KYC/AML, WALLETS AND LICENSING HANDLED FOR YOU)			
Bridge (Stripe)	Stablecoin payment acceptance across 100+ countries via the standard Stripe API. Acquired by Stripe for $1.1B.	Companies already using Stripe.	Operates under Stripe's payment processor licences globally.
BVNK	Stablecoin payment infrastructure across collections, conversion and payouts. Acquired by Mastercard for $1.8B.	Teams wanting network-backed infrastructure.	Licensed as a payment institution in multiple jurisdictions.
Merge	One API combining stablecoin settlement with local fiat rails. Multi-currency accounts in 60+ currencies and named sub-accounts for structural reconciliation. Kyriba partner since July 2026.	Teams wanting settlement without acquiring licences market by market.	Payment and e-money licences across relevant jurisdictions. Client funds ring-fenced at tier-1 banks.
CUSTODY AND INDEPENDENT INFRASTRUCTURE			
Fireblocks	MPC-based infrastructure platform for high-throughput operations across chains, exchanges and counterparties. Policy engine and multi-party approvals.	High-velocity payment and treasury operations at scale. Often paired with a partner bank or separate qualified custodian.	Infrastructure provider with select trust options, not a qualified custodian in its own right. SOC 2 Type II.
Anchorage Digital	The only federally chartered digital asset bank in the US, offering qualified custody under banking supervision.	Organizations whose policy requires a federally chartered banking counterparty.	OCC-chartered national trust bank. Subject to federal banking supervision.
BitGo	Regulated qualified custodian with multi-signature and MPC key management, plus staking and asset servicing.	Fiduciaries and regulated entities that are required to hold assets with a qualified custodian.	OCC national trust charter, plus New York and South Dakota trust charters. Insurance available.
TREASURY MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS			
Kyriba	Liquidity and treasury platform used by 4,000+ multinationals, processing $51T in payments annually. Stablecoin capability via Circle and Merge.	Teams wanting stablecoin payments inside their existing TMS.	Not a regulated issuer; compliance sits with the issuer and orchestrator selected.
SAP	Digital Currency Hub connects to S/4HANA, with stablecoin invoice settlement reconciled via ISO 20022 (camt.053) import.	Organizations running SAP as their financial system of record.	Not a regulated issuer; compliance sits with the issuer and orchestrator selected.

Eight questions to ask any provider

1. Are you licensed or regulated in the jurisdictions where we operate?

Non-negotiable. Ask for their specific regulatory status in your key markets, not just a general statement of compliance.

2. What is your reserve structure and audit cadence?

For stablecoin issuers. How is the backing held, by whom, and how frequently is it audited? Monthly attestations from a major accounting firm are the standard to expect.

3. What insurance coverage do you carry?

Institutional custody providers should carry crime and cyber insurance. Ask for coverage amounts and the carrier. Your risk committee will want this documented.

4. How do you handle institutional KYC and AML onboarding?

Onboarding should be managed by a dedicated team under Compliance (similar to existing traditional bank KYC/AML processes). A process that seems unusually light is worth examining carefully.

5. What is your historical uptime and incident response process?

The blockchain network is highly resilient. The custody and API layer above it can have downtime. Ask for uptime history and a documented incident response procedure.

6. Can you integrate with our treasury management system?

For the pilot, integration is not required. For a scaled deployment, understanding API connections with Kyriba, SAP Treasury, or your specific system is relevant. Kyriba has partnered with more than one stablecoin infrastructure provider, including Circle and Merge, making it one of the more advanced corporate treasury integrations currently available.

7. What is the complete fee structure?

Onchain transaction fees are low. However, custody, network gas fees, stablecoin/fiat and stablecoin/stablecoin conversion fees can accumulate at institutional scale. Ask for a complete fee schedule and typical spreads across all transaction types.

8. Can we speak with existing institutional treasury clients?

Reference checks are a reasonable expectation for any institutional relationship. Any credible provider will connect you with existing clients. If they cannot or are reluctant to, take that seriously.

08

Where This Goes

The longer-term opportunity for corporate treasury

A successful pilot across a few corridors is the starting point. The organizations that build stablecoin payment capabilities now are positioning themselves for a larger transition that is already underway.

Scaling from one corridor to a program

Once a treasury team has operational experience on one corridor, expanding to additional corridors is straightforward. The operating infrastructure (orchestrator or independent) and treasury policy framework are already in place. The team also has direct experience with the mechanics. The incremental cost of adding a corridor is low. The incremental benefit, particularly on high-volume EM corridors with elevated local borrowing rates, can be significant.

External supplier payments at scale

The EY-Parthenon survey found that 77% of current corporate stablecoin users name supplier payments as their primary use case. A stablecoin payment settles in minutes and generates a permanent, verifiable record. It also eliminates the correspondent banking friction that makes supplier payment confirmation a manual process in many corridors. For supply chain finance programs, faster settlement also opens up opportunities to renegotiate payment terms.

The FX opportunity, a longer-term view

Three decades running global FX markets have informed a clear view of where the constraints of the current system create cost and risk for corporate treasury functions, including the opaque FX spreads embedded in correspondent transfers, the currency exposure that accumulates during multi-day settlement windows, and the hedging costs incurred specifically because settlement timing is uncertain.

The $9.5 trillion daily FX market still settles largely on T+2 rails and relies on correspondent banks and prefunding. Stablecoin settlement does not remove that dependency entirely. Federal Reserve Board staff note that a receiving bank unwilling to hold foreign exchange risk still needs a large-bank counterparty to convert the proceeds into local currency. Transactions are also constrained by traditional banking hours. Stablecoin-based settlement addresses the timing and availability constraints. The cost of the currency conversion itself remains a separate negotiation. As non-USD stablecoin liquidity develops, the ability to execute cross-currency transactions onchain becomes increasingly practical. Circle's StableFX is one product to watch here, designed to quote and settle stablecoin pairs such as USDC and EURC onchain without prefunding or bilateral agreements. It is currently live on the Arc testnet ahead of Arc's mainnet launch, scheduled for 16 September 2026. Non-USD stablecoins are likely 5 to 10 years away from reaching liquidity levels comparable to the traditional FX market. The organizations that build operational familiarity now will be positioned to move quickly when that liquidity arrives.

Standard Chartered and Zodia Markets, in their 2026 research report 'Beyond Concentration: Where Non-USD Stablecoins Can Scale,' identify a structural divergence. USD stablecoins represent over 98% of stablecoin market cap, while the USD accounts for only approximately 50% of global cross-border payment flows. As stablecoin infrastructure scales, even modest diversification toward non-USD stablecoins would represent a material opportunity for organizations that have built the operational capability to access it.

Source: Standard Chartered / Zodia Markets, 'Beyond Concentration: Where Non-USD Stablecoins Can Scale,' 2026. BIS Triennial Survey 2025.

Conclusion

The bottom line

Many treasury teams have not put a total number on cross-border payment costs, because those costs are scattered across the business. The wire fee is easy to see. Interest expense, correspondent deductions and working capital tied up in transit sit elsewhere and are rarely added together. When they are, the total is often significant. Stablecoins are an alternative that can reduce much of that cost.

If you're taking this to your CFO or board, here's what's worth saying. Run the numbers on a single high-friction corridor first. Appendix A takes an afternoon and usually surprises people. Visa is settling billions annually in stablecoins. Hyundai Motor moved real intercompany funds between its US and Mexico entities in under ten minutes this July. An EY-Parthenon survey of 350 executives found 13% of corporates and financial institutions already using stablecoins, with 54% of non-users expecting to adopt within a year.

None of this requires betting the business. A single-corridor pilot, run alongside your existing process, costs little and tells you almost everything you need to know before deciding whether to go further.

Three steps to take

1. **Run the numbers on one corridor.** Appendix A takes an afternoon. Pull 12 months of payment data and calculate direct fees, correspondent deductions, embedded FX spread and late payment interest. That figure is your baseline, and the settlement-related components are what a pilot can test.
2. **Bring legal and compliance in early.** Budget two to four weeks for a jurisdictional analysis of your sending and receiving countries. Appendix D is a checklist your counsel can work from directly.
3. **Run a parallel pilot for 90 to 120 days.** Route a portion of live volume through the new rail alongside your existing SWIFT process, then compare both on settlement time, cost, transparency and operational effort.

A

Corridor Cost Worksheet

Estimate the annual cost of your cross-border payment infrastructure on a specific corridor. The worked figures are illustrative and vary by corridor, transfer size and banking relationship, so replace each input with your own data.

Step 1: Direct wire fees

Annual transfer volume on this corridor ($) x Average number of transfers per year x Average wire fee per transfer

Example: $50M per year, 100 transfers, $40 average fee = $4,000 per year in direct wire fees

Step 2: Correspondent bank deductions

Estimate the average amount deducted from transfers by correspondent banks vs. amount sent. Typically 0.1% to 0.5% in EM corridors.

Example: $50M x 0.25% average deduction = $125,000 per year in invisible correspondent fees

Step 3: Embedded FX spread

Estimate the spread between the market FX rate and the rate applied to your wire transfers. Typically 0.1% to 1.5% depending on corridor and bank relationship.

Example: $50M x 0.5% average spread = $250,000 per year in embedded FX cost

Step 4: Late payment interest cost

Annual volume x Share of transfers that arrive late x Local short-term corporate borrowing rate / 360 x Average delay days

Only the portion of volume that arrives late carries this cost. Use your own borrowing rate rather than the policy rate, since corporate borrowing typically sits 200 to 400 basis points above policy in EM corridors.

Example: $50M x 20% late x 9% / 360 x 2.5 days = $6,250 per year. The 9% reflects a Mexican corporate borrowing rate against a 6.50% Banxico overnight rate as of June 2026.

Step 5: Total annual cost and business case

Sum of Steps 1 through 4 = total annual cost of this corridor under existing infrastructure.

Using the example figures above, that is $4,000 + $125,000 + $250,000 + $6,250 = $385,250 per year, or roughly 77 basis points on the corridor.

Not all of this is recoverable. Wire fees, correspondent deductions and late payment interest are largely addressed by settling in minutes without intermediaries. The FX spread is a separate matter. Currency conversion is required either way, and its cost depends on market conditions, the corridor, and your dealer or banking relationship rather than on how the payment settles. In the example, roughly 27 basis points relate to the settlement mechanism. The remaining 50 is an FX negotiation that runs independently of any pilot.

A stablecoin pilot on this corridor, run over 90 to 120 days, will generate a direct comparison against this baseline. Run it for your top 3 corridors to size the opportunity across your program.

A fifth cost, measured separately

Cash sitting in transit during normal settlement is a real cost, excluded from the total above because it depends on your internal cost of capital rather than on figures you can pull from bank records.

Annual volume x Average settlement days / 360 x Your cost of capital

Example: $50M x 3 days / 360 x 5% = $20,833 per year, taking the corridor total to roughly $406,000.

Of the four costs above, this is the one a change in settlement addresses most directly. Cash that arrives in minutes rather than days is available to the business immediately.

B

Glossary

- KYC/AML: Know Your Customer and Anti-Money Laundering onboarding checks required by regulated institutions.
- Blockchain: A distributed ledger maintained simultaneously across thousands of computers. Every entry is permanent and cannot be altered. No single institution controls it.
- Stablecoin: A digital currency pegged to a real-world asset, typically the US dollar. 1 USDC = $1.00, always. It does not fluctuate and is not a speculative instrument.
- USDC: USD Coin. The leading institutional stablecoin, issued by Circle. $73.3 billion in circulation as of Q2 2026. Backed dollar-for-dollar by cash and US Treasuries. Audited monthly.
- EURC: Circle's euro stablecoin. MiCA-compliant. Issued by Circle Europe. Relevant for EUR-denominated supplier payments and intercompany flows within the EU framework.
- GENIUS Act: The Guiding and Establishing National Innovation for US Stablecoins Act, signed into law in July 2025. Establishes federal licensing requirements for payment stablecoin issuers, mandates 1:1 reserve backing, and requires Bank Secrecy Act compliance.
- MiCA: Markets in Crypto-Assets Regulation. The EU regulatory framework for stablecoins and digital assets, fully in force since 2024.
- Wallet: A digital address that can send and receive stablecoins. For institutional use, wallets are held in custody by regulated providers.
- Custodian: A regulated institution that holds digital assets on behalf of clients, similar in function to a traditional securities custodian. Examples: Anchorage Digital, BitGo, Fireblocks.
- Settlement finality: The point at which a payment is irrevocably complete. On a blockchain, finality is typically reached within seconds. On SWIFT, it can take one to five business days.
- Correspondent banking: The network of intermediary banks through which cross-border SWIFT payments are routed. Each correspondent adds processing time and fees.
- MT940: The SWIFT message format for an electronic bank statement, used by treasury systems for automated reconciliation.
- UETR: Unique End-to-end Transaction Reference. A 36-character identifier assigned to every SWIFT gpi payment, enabling end-to-end tracking across the correspondent chain.
- MT103: The SWIFT message format for a single customer credit transfer, the standard instruction format for a cross-border wire payment.
- GSIBs: Global Systemically Important Banks. A designation from the Financial Stability Board for banks whose failure could threaten the global financial system, subject to additional capital and oversight requirements.
- Deliverable currency: A currency that can be physically settled at the transaction level. USD/EUR, USD/MXN, and USD/SGD are examples of deliverable currency pairs. Non-deliverable currencies settle the differential in a reference currency and are recommended for a second phase.
- AMM (Automated Market Maker): A protocol that prices and settles trades against a pooled reserve of assets rather than matching individual buy and sell orders.
- CLOB (Central Limit Order Book): The order-matching model used by traditional exchanges, where bids and offers are ranked by price and matched directly.
- Onchain: Activity recorded on the blockchain. An onchain transaction is permanently verifiable by any authorized party at any time.
- Gas fee: The transaction cost for executing an operation on a blockchain network. Typically cents for stablecoin transfers regardless of transfer size.

C

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Jurisdictional Compliance Checklist for a First Pilot

Four questions to start with

1. Does our treasury policy currently permit holding fiat-backed stablecoins, or does it need a targeted update?

2. Is our chosen provider licensed to operate in every jurisdiction our pilot corridors touch?

3. Does the provider automatically screen every counterparty wallet against OFAC and equivalent sanctions lists?

4. Can we match every stablecoin payment back to the underlying invoice for local tax and audit purposes?

This is reference material for your General Counsel or outside counsel, not a substitute for their review. The items below are the right questions to bring into that conversation for a USD/MXN, USD/SGD, or USD/EUR pilot. **DAGA is an advisory firm, not a law firm. Every item here should be independently verified by qualified counsel licensed in the relevant jurisdiction before a pilot is funded.**

United States (the outbound foundation)

• Does our treasury policy or corporate bylaws permit classifying fiat-backed stablecoins as a cash equivalent or prepaid FX settlement asset, distinct from speculative digital assets?

• Is our selected provider registered as a Money Services Business with FinCEN and licensed as a Money Transmitter in our relevant home states?

• Does the transaction engine screen every recipient, intermediary, and counterparty wallet against OFAC and equivalent sanctions lists in real time, before funds move?

• Have we established sub-ledger accounting controls under U.S. GAAP for the short-term holding of tokens and any exchange-rate gain or loss between purchase and settlement?

Mexico corridor (USD to MXN)

• Does the local off-ramp partner operate under a valid license from the Comisión Nacional Bancaria y de Valores under Mexico's Ley Fintech?

• Does the settlement engine deliver directly into a valid 18-digit CLABE account through Mexico's SPEI real-time network?

• Is there a process linking each stablecoin payment to the supplier's official CFDI electronic invoice for SAT tax audit purposes?

Singapore corridor (USD to SGD)

• Does our Singapore-side provider hold a valid Major Payment Institution license covering Digital Payment Token services from the Monetary Authority of Singapore?

• Does the provider convert and deliver fiat SGD directly into Singapore's FAST or PayNow corporate banking networks?

• Has our tax team confirmed the GST treatment of converting USDC into SGD tokens under IRAS guidance?

European Union corridor (USD to EUR)

• Is the European provider a fully authorized Crypto-Asset Service Provider, or an authorized Electronic Money Institution, operating under MiCA?

• If the pilot uses a euro stablecoin such as EURC, is the issuer an authorized EMI under MiCA Title III/IV?

• Do we have an identity-sharing protocol that satisfies the EU Transfer of Funds Regulation for every transaction leg?

The starting frame for this conversation is that your entities can already legally send and receive traditional fiat wires in each of these markets. This review is scoped narrowly, confirming the regulatory, tax, and licensing treatment of using a fiat-backed stablecoin as the routing mechanism before funds re-enter the local banking system, not re-litigating whether cross-border payments themselves are permitted.

About the Author



Robert Valdes-Rodriguez

Founder and CEO, Digital Asset Global Advisors (DAGA)

New York, NY

Robert Valdes-Rodriguez brings thirty-five years of global financial markets experience to Digital Asset Global Advisors. He has led FX, Emerging Markets, and Derivatives businesses across 70 countries at some of the world's largest banks, including ABN AMRO, UBS, Scotiabank, and Credit Agricole.

He began investing personally in Bitcoin in 2019, a conviction shaped by decades of watching how global financial infrastructure works and where its friction points lie. He then spent five years operating inside the digital asset industry as an executive committee member at two leading firms, as Global Head of Sales at Abra and Chief Commercial Officer at Keyrock.

That background is the foundation of DAGA, someone who has sat on both sides of the table and can help clients bridge the gap between traditional finance and digital assets with confidence.

Open to board and advisory engagements where this experience adds real value to your organization.

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DAGA works with corporate treasuries, banks, asset managers and boards to evaluate, adopt and manage digital asset strategies. We hold no commercial relationship with any provider named in this report.

WEBSITE	daga.io
EMAIL	rvr@daga.io
LINKEDIN	linkedin.com/in/robert-vr

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